

Week 1: Apologetics

BIG IDEA

Apologetics comes from the Greek apologia in 1 Peter 3:15: giving a reasoned defense for the hope we have, with gentleness and respect. This year asks students, and you, to know why you believe what you believe and to discuss it intelligently.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Peter commands believers to be prepared to give a reason, a courtroom-style defense, for their faith; that word apologia is where apologetics comes from.
- Peter wrote to Christians persecuted by Rome, and that same responsibility to stand and defend belief applies to us today.
- Being called to give a defense also means being capable of one; Peter in Acts 4:20 could not stop speaking of what he had seen and heard.
- Some cite 1 Corinthians 2 to claim persuasion is dangerous, but in context Paul is not forbidding reasoned evidence; Jesus, Paul, and Peter all gave good reasons.
- Create an environment where students can ask anything, even questions that voice doubt, and feel safe doing it.
- You do not need every answer; saying 'let's figure this out together' builds the relationship and finds the answer, using church, seminary, and Awana resources.

SCRIPTURE

1 Peter 3:15 • Acts 4:20 • 1 Corinthians 2

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Why do you believe what you believe, and can you discuss those beliefs intelligently?
2. Do your students feel free to ask any question, including ones that voice doubt? What would make it safer?
3. How will you respond when a student asks something you cannot answer?
4. What resources or people could you draw on this year when hard questions come up?

Summary of the Week 1 Leader Video for this church's Awana® leaders — internal ministry use only. Awana® and Journey: Advocates® are trademarks of Awana Clubs International. This summary is not affiliated with or endorsed by Awana; content follows the Leader Video's transcript ([public/transcripts/week-01-leader.vtt](https://public.transcripts/week-01-leader.vtt)).